C-E-002187A(Army-GL)
September 26, 1985
SUPERSEDING
C-E-002187 (Army-GL)
31 March 1983

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

EGG LOAF WITH HAM, THERMOSTABILIZED, TRAY PACK

This interim Federal specification was developed by the U.S. Army Natick Research and Development Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014 based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers egg loaf with ham, thermostabilized in tray pack cans for use by the Department of Defense as a component of operational rations.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

TT-C-495	-	Coatings, Exterior, for Tinned Food Cans
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal specifications, standards, and commercial item descriptions as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specification, Standards and Commercial Item Descriptions. The Index, which includes cumulative bimonthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification, and other Federal specifications, and commercial item descriptions required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from General Services Administration Business Service Centers in Boston, MA; New York, NY; Philadelphia, PA; Washington, DC; Atlanta, GA; Chicago, IL; Kansas City, MO; Fort Worth, TX; Houston, TX; Denver, CO; San Francisco, CA; Los Angeles, CA; and Seattle, WA.

FSC 8940

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Military Specifications

MIL-L-1497 - Labeling of Metal Cans for Subsistence Items
MIL-L-35078 - Loads, Unit: Preparation of Nonperishable - Subsistence Items; General Specification for

Military Standard:

MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage

(Copies of Military specifications and standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

Laws and Regulations:

U.S. Department of Health and Human Services

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder (21 CFR Parts 1-199)

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

U.S. Department of Agriculture (USDA)

Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

Regulations Governing the Inspection of Eggs and Egg Products (Egg Products Inspection Act of 1970) (7 CFR Part 59)

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Director, Poultry Division, AMS, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

U.S. Standards for Condition of Food Containers

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Director, Food Quality Assurance Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

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Environmental Protection Agency (EPA)

National Interim Primary Drinking Water Regulations

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Office of Drinking Water WH550, Environmental Protection Agency, Washington, DC 20460.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

National Academy of Sciences

Food Chemicals Codex

(Application for copies should be addressed to the National Academy Press, 2101 Constitution Avenue, N.W., Washington, DC 20418.)

(Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified, a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.3, 6.1, and 6.3).

3.2 Ingredients. All ingredients shall be clean, sound, wholesome, and free from foreign material, evidence of rodent and insect infestation, extraneous material, off-odors, off-flavors, and off-colors.

3.2.1 Whole eggs. Whole eggs may be liquid or frozen and shall have been inspected in accordance with the Regulations Governing the Inspection of Eggs and Egg Products (7 CFR Part 59). The whole eggs shall be egg whites and egg yolks in their natural proportions as broken directly from the shell as evidenced by a USDA Egg Products Inspection Certificate. The whole eggs shall contain no food additives and shall be in satisfactory condition, free of objectionable odors, such as musty, sour, or fruity, and free from foreign material. Liquid whole eggs shall be held at a temperature of 40°F or lower and shall be held for not more than 72 hours from the time of pasteurization until the start of formulation of the product in which they are used. Frozen whole eggs shall be held at 10°F or lower and used within 120 days. Frozen whole eggs shall be thawed and held at a temperature of 40°F or lower and shall be held for not more than 24 hours prior to use in the product.

3.2.2 Ham, canned or cooked. The ham shall be high commercial grade. Smoke flavoring shall be added. The ham shall not be labeled "water added" and shall not contain dextrose. The canned or cooked hams shall be maintained in the temperature range of 28° to 40°F for a period of time not to exceed 60 days from the date of pack until preparation of the finished product (see 3.3).

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3.2.3 Cream cheese, fresh. The fresh cream cheese shall conform to the Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act, Standard of Identity for Cream Cheese (21 CFR 133.133). The cream cheese shall have a creamy flavor and shall be moderately salted. The cream cheese may have a very slight acid flavor and aroma or slight cooked flavor. The body and texture shall be smooth and creamy. The cream cheese shall be uniformly white in color. The cream cheese shall not be coarse, crumbly, gummy, grainy, sticky, nor have any free whey present.

3.2.4 Microcrystalline cellulose. Microcrystalline cellulose shall be a gel forming cellulose composed of 85 parts microcrystalline cellulose and 15 parts sodium carboxymethylcellulose. It shall be a white, water dispersible powder which shall retain less than 0.1 percent on a standard 60 mesh screen and less than 50 percent on a standard 325 mesh screen and have an average particle size of 28 microns in dispersion. The microcrystalline cellulose shall have an ash content of not more than 2 percent and a heavy metals content of less than 10 parts per million. The pH of a 2 percent dispersion shall be not less than 6 and not more than 8 and have an acid demand requiring 2.2 milliliters of 0.1 normal hydrochloric acid to change the pH of 100 milliliters of a 1 percent solids dispersion to pH 4. The microcrystalline cellulose shall be insoluble in water and organic solvents but be dispersible in water to form colloidal sols and gels.

3.2.5 Oil, vegetable. The vegetable oil shall have a stability of 15 hours (minimum), a free fatty acid content not to exceed 0.05 percent by weight, a moisture/volatile matter not to exceed 0.06 percent by weight and shall pass the cold test of 5.5 hours (minimum).

3.2.6 Pepper, white, ground. Ground white pepper shall be derived from the dried mature berries of Piper nigrum L. from which the outer covering or outer and inner coverings have been removed. Volatile oil content shall be not less than 1 mL per 100 grams.

3.2.7 Citric acid. Citric acid shall be as specified in the Food Chemicals Codex.

3.2.8 Water. Water used for formulation, ice-making, and washing shall conform to the National Interim Primary Drinking Water Regulations.

3.2.9 Preblended spice and seasoning mixture. Preblended spices and seasonings may be used. The spices and seasonings in the mixture shall comply with the requirements of this specification. The containers used for the spice and seasoning blend shall be labeled with each ingredient and the percentage of each ingredient in the blend. The ingredients shall be in the same proportions as specified in the ingredient formula.

3.3 Preparation and further processing.

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3.3.1 Preparation of ham. The ham shall be ground once through a 0.5-inch plate, then cooked in a steam-jacketed kettle at a temperature and time to produce a 25 to 30 percent cook-out of broth without scorching the ham particles. The broth shall be drained from the cooked ham. The cooked ham and the broth shall immediately be used in the preparation of the egg loaf and ham (see 3.3.3). If not used immediately, the cooked ham and ham broth shall be rapidly cooled to a temperature range of 28° to 40°F and held in that temperature range for not more than 48 hours before being combined with the other ingredients in preparing the product.

3.3.2 Preparation of microcrystalline cellulose. The microcrystalline cellulose shall be combined with 75 percent of the water and ham broth and mixed in equipment that provides a high degree of shear, such as an homogenizer, vertical cutter-mixer, or other similar equipment. Planetary mixers, lightning mixers, or the like, shall not be used. Proper dispersion of the microcrystalline cellulose in the water and broth shall be demonstrated by a pudding-like (gel-like) consistency and a flow on a CENCO (Bostwick) viscosimeter of 0.0 to 0.5 cm at 70°F in three minutes.

3.3.3 Preparation of the egg loaf and ham. The egg loaf and ham shall be prepared as follows:

Ingredients	Percent by weight
Whole eggs	54.92
Ham	30.00
Water and ham broth	10.53
Cream cheese, fresh	3.02
Microcrystalline cellulose	0.82
Oil, vegetable	0.63
Pepper, white, ground	0.05
Citric acid	0.03

a. The cream cheese shall be mixed with sufficient water and ham broth (cooled to 100°F or less) to produce a thin slurry. The slurry shall be heated to 140°F with continuous stirring in a steam-jacketed kettle until the cheese is completely melted. The citric acid, pepper, vegetable oil, and the remainder of the water and ham broth shall be added and thoroughly mixed in.

b. The cream cheese slurry and the eggs (thawed) shall be gradually added to the microcystalline cellulose gel. (Failure to thin the microcystalline cellulose gel gradually will result in gel lumps which cannot be broken up.) The cooked, ground ham shall then be slowly added and mixed only until fully dispersed in the egg, cream cheese, microcrystalline cellulose gel mixture. Mixing must be at slow speed to prevent air pockets.

c. The product shall be filled into the tray pack cans immediately following preparation.

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3.4 Tray pack filling and sealing. Each tray pack can shall be filled with product so as to conform to the finished product requirements and to the following requirements:

a. Each can shall be hermetically sealed (under a vacuum of not less than 10 inches of mercury) immediately after filling.

b. The filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be in the retort process within one hour after being filled.

3.5 Tray pack thermoprocessing. The filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be thermostabilized by retorting at 240°F until a minimum sterilization value (F_o) of 6 has been achieved.

3.6 Finished product requirements. The finished product shall comply with the following requirements:

a. There shall be no foreign material, such as, but not limited to dirt, insect, insect parts, hair, wood, paper, paint, glass, or metal.

b. There shall be no foreign odor or flavor, such as, but not limited to rancid, scorched, burnt, stale, sour, musty, moldy, or sulfurous.

c. There shall be no color foreign to the product.

d. The average net weight shall be not less than 104 ounces.

e. No individual can shall contain less than 102 ounces of product.

f. The product shall have a typical yellow cooked egg color.

g. The product shall be free from gel lumps.

h. Free liquid per can shall not weigh more than 1 ounce.

3.6.1 Palatability. The finished product shall be equal to or better than the preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance.

3.7 Plant qualification. The meat component and the finished product shall originate and be produced, processed, and stored in plants regularly operating under Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations of the U.S. Department of Agriculture.

3.8 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

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4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Contractor's responsibility. Inspection and acceptance by the USDA shall not relieve the contractor of obligation and responsibility to deliver a product complying with all requirements of this specification. The contractor shall assure product compliance prior to submitting it to the USDA for any inspection.

4.2 Inspection and certification. Product acceptability shall be determined by USDA. The USDA will determine the degree of supervision necessary to assure compliance with the requirements of this specification.

4.3 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.1), it shall be inspected in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of this specification and evaluated for overall appearance and palatability. Any failure to conform to the quality assurance provisions of this specification or any appearance or palatability failure shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

4.4 Component and material inspection. Components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings, and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.4.1 Ingredient and component examination. Conformance of ingredients and components to identity, condition and other requirements specified in 3.2 shall be certified by the ingredient supplier or ingredient manufacturer, or compliance be evident by examination of pertinent labels, markings, US Grade Certificates, certificates of analyses or other such valid documents acceptable to the inspection agency. In addition, prior to use, each ingredient shall be examined organoleptically as necessary, to determine conformance to the condition requirements. Any nonconformance to an identity, condition, or other requirement shall be cause for rejection of the ingredient or component lot or of any involved product.

4.5 In-process examination. In-process examination shall be performed to determine conformance to the preparation, processing, can interior coating, filling, sealing, and packing requirements. Any nonconformance revealed by actual examination or by review of records of time, temperature, and formulation or of other valid documents shall be cause for rejection of the involved product.

4.6 Tray pack inspection. The inspection lot shall include only tray packs produced in one workshift. The USDA reserves the right to separate the inspection lot into smaller inspection lots.

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4.6.1 Net weight inspection. Randomly select 30 filled and sealed tray pack cans from the inspection lot and weigh separately. Subtract the average tare weight (determined by randomly selecting and weighing 30 of the empty tray pack cans and lids used in preparing the product and dividing the total weight by 30) from the weight of each tray pack in the sample. Results shall be reported to the nearest 1 ounce. If the average net weight is less than 104 ounces or if the net weight of any individual can is less than 102 ounces, the lot shall be rejected.

4.6.2 Product inspection. The sample size shall be as indicated by the double sampling plan specified in table I. The tray pack cans shall be selected at random from the lot. The tray pack cans shall be heated at least 15 minutes in 140° to 150°F water, opened, and inspected for the defects listed in table II.

TABLE I. Double sampling plan for product inspection. 1/

Lot size (cans)	Sample size (No. of cans)	Cumulative sample	Acceptance number	Rejection number
0-3200	8		0	2
	8	16	1	2
3201-35000	13		0	3
	13	26	3	4

1/ a. If no defects are found in the first sample, the lot shall be accepted.

b. If the number of defects found in the first sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.

c. If the number of defects found in the first sample exceeds the acceptance number but are less than the rejection number, the second sample shall be inspected. Defects found in the first and second samples shall be combined and if the number of defects in the cumulative sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.

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TABLE II. Product defects 1/ 2/

Category	Defect
Major	
151	Mild to strong sulfurous odor.
152	Does not possess a typical yellow cooked egg color. 3/
153	Presence of gel lumps. 3/
154	Free liquid in a can weighs more than 1.0 ounce. 3/
155	Presence of bone measuring more than 0.3 inch or cartilage measuring more than 0.5 inch.

1/ The presence of any foreign material (e.g., glass, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, metal, etc.), foreign odor or flavor (e.g., burnt, scorched, moldy, musty, rancid, sour, stale, etc.) or foreign color shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

2/ Product not equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability or overall appearance shall be cause for rejection of the lot. (This comparison shall be performed only when deemed necessary by an AMS agent.

3/ To determine the weights of free liquid, and to inspect for gel lumps, color, bone and cartilage the following procedure shall be used. The can shall be cut, and with the can end in place, shall be inverted and drained for 1 minute, collecting the free liquid. The product shall be divided into ten approximately equal portions and examined for gel lumps and discoloration.

4.7 Can condition examination. Examination of filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be in accordance with the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers except that inspection for labeling shall be in accordance with MIL-L-1497 (see 5.4).

4.8 Shipping container examination. Shipping containers shall be examined for defects in assembly, closure, and reinforcement (when applicable) in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. In addition, the following defects shall be classified as follows: Major: (1) National stock number, item

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description, contract number, or date of pack markings missing, incorrect, or illegible; (2) Reinforcement with nonmetallic strapping or tape is not used. Minor: (1) Other required markings missing, incorrect, or illegible; (2) Interior packing with fiberboard liner or pads not as specified; (3) Height of box liner less than inside depth dimension of box by more than 1/8 inch or extends above top edge of box; (4) Length or width of pads less than box dimensions by more than 1/8 inch; (5) Arrangement or number of cans not as specified.

4.9 Unit load inspection. Inspection of unit loads shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-L-35078.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. The product shall be packaged in accordance with level A or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A. A size 1001 by 1206 by 200 tray pack can shall be filled with 104 ounces of the food product, sealed, and thermoprocessed as specified in 3.4, 3.5 and 3.6. The base plate of the can shall be electrolytic chromium-coated steel and shall be of sufficient temper to protect the product during shipment and storage. The base plate weight of the body and end of each can shall be 90 pounds per base box. The entire inside area of the can shall be coated. Scratches or fractures shall not penetrate through the interior can coating. The interior can coating shall not peel or blister when in contact with the product. The interior can coating shall neither affect nor be affected by the packaged product. A certificate of conformance shall be furnished to certify compliance with the interior can coating requirements. The can shall be coated overall on the outside with a coating conforming to type I of TT-C-495.

5.1.2 Level C. The product shall be packaged as specified in 5.1.1, except that cans with commercial exterior coating will be acceptable.

5.2 Packing. The product shall be packed in accordance with level A, B or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A packing. Four cans of product, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC-L, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The cans shall be packed flat, four in depth within the box. The inside of each box shall be provided with a box liner and five fiberboard pads. The height of the box liner shall be equal to the full inside depth of the box (+0 inch, -1/8 inch). The pads shall not be less than 1/8 inch of the full length and width dimensions of the box and shall be fabricated of grade V3c fiberboard. The pads shall be placed between the cans and on the top and bottom of the stacked cans. Each fiberboard box shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-

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sensitive adhesive filament reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified (see 6.1). Strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for type II, class F loads.

5.2.2 Level B packing. Four cans of product, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed as specified in 5.2.1, except the box shall be constructed of grade V3c, V3s, or V4s fiberboard.

5.2.3 Level C packing. Four cans of product, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC-L, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The cans shall be packed flat, four in depth within the box. The inside of each box shall be provided with a box liner and five fiberboard pads. The height of the box liner shall be equal to the full inside depth of the box (+0 inch, -1/8 inch). The pads shall be placed between the cans and on the top and bottom of the stacked cans. The pad dimensions shall be not less than 1/8 inch of the full length and width dimensions of the box and shall be fabricated of the same material as the box.

5.3 Unit loading. When specified (see 6.1), the product, packed as specified in 5.2.2 and 5.2.3, shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified. When unit loads are strapped, the strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping.

5.4 Labeling. Each tray pack can shall be labeled in accordance with MIL-L-1497. In addition, the name of product shall be marked, stamping is permitted, on one 1001 by 200 side of the can. The labeling shall be legible when examined in accordance with 4.7 after submerging the can in boiling water for 30 minutes. Paper labels are not permitted. Cans shall show the following statements:

TO HEAT

a. To heat in water: Submerge unopened can in boiling water. Simmer gently 35 minutes. Avoid overheating to the point where internal pressure is evident (can shows evidence of bulging). Remove from water and open lid for serving.
CAUTION: Use care when opening as pressure may have been generated within the can.

b. To heat in oven: Either punch several holes in lid of tray can or open can in usual manner leaving the loose lid in place to prevent moisture loss. Place in a 350°F oven for approximately 35 to 40 minutes until contents reach an internal temperature of 165°F.
WARNING: Do not place closed can in oven as heating will increase internal pressure which may cause the can to burst.

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YIELD

Approximately 20 servings of 5 ounces each.

5.5 Marking.

5.5.1 Shipping containers. In addition to any special marking required by the contract, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.5.2 Unit loads. Unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-L-35078. In addition, the following precautionary marking in capital letters larger than other markings shall be included:

CAUTION: DO NO STACK PALLETS IN TRANSIT OR MORE THAN TWO HIGH IN STORAGE.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. When a first article is required (see 3.1, 4.3 and 6.3).
c. Provisions for approved preproduction samples (see 3.6.1, and 6.3).
d. Level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
e. Type and class of unit load when unit loading is required (see 5.2.1 and 5.3).

6.2 Appropriate level of pack. Based on the conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipment, handling and storage of the specific item being procured, the procuring activity should select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with the criteria established in AR 700-15/NAVSUPINST 4030.28/AFR 71-6/MCO 4030.33A/DLAR 4145.7.

6.3 First article inspection. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of FAR 52.209. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all procurement documents regarding arrangements for selection, inspection and approval, of the first article.

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 8940-A492

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NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document*(s)* or to amend contractual requirements.

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
C-E-002187A(Army-GL)	EGG LOAF WITH HAM, THERMOSTABILIZED, TRAY PACK

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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